

GST workspace — CA how-to guide

For the chartered accountant / tax team preparing GSTR-1, GSTR-3B, ITC, and e-invoice JSON.

This app does not file the return. It classifies books and downloads offline GSTN JSON. You upload and file on gst.gov.in. Issued invoice numbers and tax rupees are never rewritten. It does not generate an IRN, pull GSTR-2B live, or store GSTN passwords.

1. Monthly picture

1–2 Open GST workspace, pick month/year. Save company GSTIN in Settings (once).	→	3 Overview: fix store/vendor GSTINs, then Preview & backfill until orange badges are gone.
4–5 GSTR-1 tab: review register, download JSON, upload on gst.gov.in → Returns → GSTR-1 → Prepare Offline.	→	6 Lock the period. Mark GSTR-1 filed and save ARN.
7–8 ITC: upload GSTR-2B JSON from the portal, download Excel. GSTR-3B: check table 3.1, download JSON.	→	9–10 File 3B on the portal, mark filed + ARN. If IRN is required, E-invoice tab → NIC bulk tool.

Rule of thumb: Overview until orange badges are gone → GSTR-1 JSON → portal → lock → 3B / ITC.

2. How to open it

1. Sign in to **SimpliPharma Admin**.
2. Left menu: **GST** → **GST workspace** (path /gst).
3. Permission **Can edit GST settings** is required to save settings, backfill, lock, or mark filed. Without it you can still view and download.

Control	What it does
Month / Year	GST return period (Indian calendar month, IST). April 2026 → GSTR fp 042026.
Status chip	open → gstr1 ready (locked) → gstr1 filed → gstr3b filed.
Lock period	Stops backfill and new bills dated in this month.
Reopen	Unlocks books. Use only if the portal file was not final.
Mark GSTR-1 / 3B filed	After filing on gst.gov.in. Optional ARN is stored on the period.
Settings	Company GSTIN, legal name, address, state, filing frequency, e-invoice flag.
Tabs	Overview · GSTR-1 · GSTR-3B · ITC / GSTR-2B · E-invoice. Orange badge = missing GST snapshot.

3. One-time: company GST settings

Open **Settings** (top right of the GST bar). Fill legal name, trade name, **15-character GSTIN**, address, state + state code, pincode, phone, email, drug licence.

- **Filing frequency:** Monthly or QRMP. QRMP only sets `filing_typ`: Q on the JSON; you still pick a month for the books.
- **E-invoice (IRN) required:** Turn on only if turnover requires IRN. Enables IRP JSON download. Does *not* call NIC.

Click **Save settings**. Format is checked (15 characters). There is no GSTN check-digit or portal lookup.

4. Overview — clean the books before export

4.1 Cards

- **Company GSTIN** — from settings.
- **This month — invoiced orders** — invoices vs snapshots.
- **Master-data exceptions** — invalid store/vendor GSTIN; medicines with no HSN (code).

4.2 Exception actions

Severity	Typical message	What you do
Info	N sales / CN / DN / PI have no GST snapshot	Preview & backfill
Warning	Store has no GSTIN	Fix GSTIN — blank is allowed (B2C)
Error	Store / vendor GSTIN is not 15 characters	Fix GSTIN
Warning	Medicines have no HSN	Open inventory and fill medicine code . New lines without HSN use 300490 .

Fix GSTINs **before** backfill when you can. Backfill uses the GSTIN at the time you run it. Changing a GSTIN later does not rewrite old snapshots.

4.3 Backfill (historical invoices)

1. Click **Process this period** or **Preview & backfill**.
2. Read the preview (counts + sample CGST/SGST split).
3. Confirm. Only a gst snapshot is written. Invoice numbers and tax rupees stay as billed.

Backfill is faithful to the issued bill: existing tax split as intra-state CGST + SGST (place of supply = company state). It does *not* re-rate mixed 5%/12% lines on old invoices. **New** fulfilments and notes store line-level HSN, rate, taxable, tax (one GSTR-1 item per rate). Locked periods must be reopened before backfill.

5. GSTR-1 — outward supplies JSON

You will see B2B / B2CL / B2CS / CDNR / CDNUR / HSN counts, GSTIN, fp, SHA-256 hash, file size, warnings, and an invoice register (number, date, type, party, rates, taxable, tax, total — first 400 rows).

Type	Meaning in this app
B2B	Buyer GSTIN is a valid 15 characters
B2CL	Unregistered, inter-state, invoice value $\geq$ ₹1 lakh (from August 2024)
B2CS	Other B2C (including small inter-state)
CDNR	Credit / debit note to a registered buyer
CDNUR	Credit / debit note to unregistered

JSON version **GST3.2.1**. Document numbers cleaned to GSTN-safe characters (max 16). Mixed-rate invoices emit one item per rate. Files over **5 MB** are rejected.

Download and upload

1. If the register is empty or snapshots are missing → Overview and backfill.
2. Click **Download GSTR-1 JSON**.
3. Confirm **Lock this period** when asked (stores filename, SHA-256 hash, fingerprints for amendments).
4. On **gst.gov.in**: Returns → **GSTR-1** → **Prepare Offline** → upload
returns_MMYYYY_GSTR1_<GSTIN>.json → validate in the GSTN offline tool → file.
5. In the app: **Mark GSTR-1 filed** and paste the **ARN**.

After lock, **Download amendment JSON** emits B2BA / CDNRA only for invoices whose fingerprint changed. B2CS cannot go in amendment tables here.

6. Period lock

open Backfill and dated writes allowed	gstr1 ready Locked after GSTR-1 download	gstr1 filed ARN saved after portal file	gstr3b filed Month closed for GST
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While status is not open you cannot fulfil a sales order, or create a credit note, debit note, purchase invoice, or purchase return, **dated in that month**, and you cannot backfill. Reopen only if you will regenerate JSON and re-upload if already filed.

7. ITC / GSTR-2B

The app cannot pull 2B from GSTN. Download GSTR-2B JSON from the portal, then click **Upload GSTR-2B JSON**.

Status	Meaning
matched	Same vendor GSTIN + invoice number; taxable/tax within ₹1
amount mismatch	Found on both sides, figures differ

Status	Meaning
books only	In SimpliPharma, not in uploaded 2B (or vendor GSTIN missing)
portal only	In 2B, not in this month's purchase books

Eligible ITC is from inward snapshots with a valid vendor GSTIN; purchase returns reverse ITC. Use **Download ITC Excel** for working papers. ITC is not auto-claimed on the portal.

8. GSTR-3B

Table 3.1 row	Source in this app
(a) Outward taxable supplies	Sales invoices + debit notes – credit notes (snapshots)
(b) Zero rated	Always 0
(c) Nil / exempt	Always 0
(d) Reverse charge inward	Always 0
(e) Non-GST outward	Always 0

ITC (OTH) = purchase invoices with valid vendor GSTIN, net of purchase returns. Reverse charge, imports, ISD, and nil are not captured — add them on the portal if they apply.

1. Review 3.1 vs GSTR-1 and 2B workings.
2. **Download GSTR-3B JSON.**
3. gst.gov.in → Returns → GSTR-3B. Confirm 3.1 and ITC.
4. **Mark GSTR-3B filed** and save ARN.

9. E-invoice (IRP JSON)

Only if **E-invoice (IRN) required** is on in Settings. Downloads IRP JSON version 1.1 for B2B invoices with a snapshot. Upload in the NIC / e-invoice bulk / taxpayer tool. The app does not generate an IRN, call NIC, or create e-way bills. IRN is not written back onto the SimpliPharma invoice in this version.

10. What lands in GST automatically

Document	When snapshot is written
Sales invoice	Order fulfilment, if that month is still open
Credit note (return / ledger)	When the note is issued
Debit note (ledger)	When the note is issued
Purchase invoice	When the PI is saved
Purchase return	When the PR is saved

11. CA checklist

Before the 11th (GSTR-1 monthly)

- ☐ Month/year correct on the GST bar
- ☐ Company GSTIN and state code in Settings
- ☐ Store / vendor GSTINs fixed on Overview
- ☐ Backfill run; orange badges at or near zero
- ☐ GSTR-1 register reviewed (types, rates, HSN)
- ☐ JSON downloaded and validated in GSTN offline tool
- ☐ Uploaded and filed on gst.gov.in
- ☐ Period locked; GSTR-1 marked filed; ARN saved

Before GSTR-3B due date

- ☐ GSTR-2B JSON uploaded on ITC tab; mismatches explained
- ☐ ITC Excel archived
- ☐ 3.1 grid agrees with GSTR-1 (net of notes)
- ☐ Manual 3B rows on portal if RCM / import / ISD / nil apply
- ☐ GSTR-3B filed on gst.gov.in
- ☐ GSTR-3B marked filed; ARN saved
- ☐ If IRN required: IRP JSON processed in NIC tool

12. Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely cause	Action
"Nothing to export. Backfill this period first."	No snapshots	Overview → Process this period
GSTR-1 warning: N documents have no snapshot	Legacy bills	Backfill; refresh GSTR-1
Cannot fulfil / save PI in a past month	Period locked	Reopen only if you will re-export
Invoice classified B2C unexpectedly	Store GSTIN blank/invalid when snapshot was written	Fix GSTIN; only new invoices pick it up
Mixed 5% and 12% on an old invoice show as one rate	Backfill is header-level	Accept for history; new fulfilments are line-level
ITC not claimed	Vendor GSTIN missing/invalid on the PI	Fix vendor GSTIN before creating the PI
File larger than 5 MB	Very large month	GSTN hard limit; contact ops
E-invoice button disabled	Flag off, or no B2B snapshots	Enable e-invoice in Settings; backfill / fulfil B2B

13. What this screen will never do

- File GSTR-1 or GSTR-3B by itself
- Log in to GSTN or store portal passwords
- Generate IRN or e-way bill numbers
- Recalculate or change a bill already sent to the retailer
- Fill 3B reverse charge, imports, or ISD from operations data
- Prove a GSTIN with the official check digit or GSTN search

14. Who to ask internally

Topic	Owner
Login, GST permission, locking a period	SimpliPharma admin / ops
Store / vendor GSTIN, HSN on medicines	Ops / master data
Issued invoice vs snapshot mismatch	Ops (do not edit tax on a processed invoice for GST)
Portal filing, ARN, 2B download	CA / tax team

SimpliPharma Admin · GST workspace · Offline GSTN JSON (GSTR-1 GST3.2.1, GSTR-3B, GSTR-2B match, IRP 1.1). Amounts on issued documents are not rewritten.